

FRUIT AND SEEDS

Full of vitamins and minerals with potent health-boosting properties, fruit and seeds not only enhance the healing effect of the tisane, but also improve the taste.

BLUEBERRIES

(Generally *Vaccinium cyanococcus*, and specifically *Vaccinium angustifolium*, wild blueberry)

The dark bluish-purple color of blueberries indicates the presence of anthocyanins—antioxidants that contribute to cell and cardiovascular health, and have cognitive benefits. Blueberries also contain the carotenoid lutein, which is associated with good eye health.



Blueberries



ELDERBERRIES

(*Sambucus nigra*)

These dark indigo berries are from the same tree that produces the elderflower (see p138). They contain anthocyanins, which have strong antioxidant qualities, as well as the immune-boosting quercetin. Traditionally, elderberry has been used to treat coughs and colds. It is also good for eye and heart health. Only pick the dark purple, fully ripe berries, and avoid green or partially ripe berries and stems, as these are toxic. Elderberries may be dried, or dehydrated, for use in tisanes.

CITRUS PEEL

Either dried or freshly grated citrus peel can be used in tisanes. It acts primarily on the digestive and respiratory systems, and provides relief for sore throats, flu, and arthritis. Choose organic, unwaxed, pesticide-free citrus, as any harmful chemicals tend to remain on, and even in, the skin.

